

# DOCUMENT 1.2 — PROBLEM STATEMENT

Folder 1: Ideation Phase | ServiceNow Capstone Project Submission

**Project Title:** Hospital Appointment Management System

**Application Scope:** x\_2065601\_hospit\_0

**Platform:** ServiceNow (Scoped Application)

**Author / Student:** Santhosh Akkiseti

## Overview

This document defines the core operational pain points using the design thinking Empathy-Based Problem Statement framework. By capturing the distinct perspectives of Patients, Doctors, and Front Desk Personnel, the system design aligns directly with real-world clinical and user workflow requirements.

## Persona 1: Patient Perspective

### Persona Profile: Seeking OPD Consultation

*"I am a patient seeking timely outpatient medical consultation, I'm trying to schedule an appointment with a specialist based on real-time availability, but I am forced to rely on congested phone lines or physical walk-ins without prior slot visibility, because the hospital lacks a self-service digital booking portal, which makes me feel anxious, frustrated, and uncertain about my healthcare access."*

**Context:** Patients frequently face long hold times when calling clinic desks or arrive in person only to discover that doctor schedules are fully booked for the day. Without real-time slot transparency or automated waitlists, cancellations lead to wasted travel time and delayed care. A self-service portal with instant slot locking directly mitigates this friction.

## Persona 2: Doctor Perspective

### Persona Profile: Attending Specialist / Medical Officer

*"I am an attending physician managing a busy daily outpatient schedule, I'm trying to efficiently conduct patient consultations within structured daily capacity limits, but my queue is frequently disrupted by double-bookings and unmanaged slot cancellations, because there is no automated real-time slot locking or waitlist auto-fulfillment system, which makes me feel overwhelmed, stressed, and unable to provide optimal patient care."*

**Context:** Doctors experience operational overload when manual booking tools fail to enforce capacity limits, leading to schedule overlaps. Additionally, last-minute patient cancellations result in idle gaps that could otherwise be utilized by urgent waitlisted patients. An automated queue and atomic slot engine provide predictable daily schedules and maximize clinical efficiency.

## Persona 3: Front-Desk / Admin Perspective

### Persona Profile: Hospital Receptionist / OPD Administrator

*"I am a front-desk administrator managing daily patient intakes and queue coordination, I'm trying to register walk-ins, confirm appointments, and maintain smooth doctor queues, but I am inundated with repetitive phone inquiries and manual log entries, because the hospital lacks an integrated, multi-role scheduling system linked to platform records, which makes me feel overworked, prone to administrative errors, and exhausted."*

**Context:** Front-desk staff spend significant effort answering availability inquiries and resolving scheduling conflicts caused by paper or spreadsheet-based records. Without a centralized, role-based portal that writes directly to transactional database tables, administrative overhead remains high and prone to manual entry errors.